Exp 4: Data Modelling and Form Design for a Business Application in Zoho Creator (Event Registration Form)

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1. Aim

To design and build a functional “Event Registration Form” application in Zoho Creator that demonstrates the correct usage of the Basic Fields available in the Form Builder, while solving a real event-management requirement of pre-registering participants for a technical workshop and recording their session preferences in advance.

The exercise is intended to reinforce the complete low-code application-building workflow — starting from identifying a genuine business problem, translating that problem into a structured data model, choosing the correct field types for each piece of information being collected, and finally validating the design by capturing and reviewing real submissions through the generated report view. In doing so, the experiment covers not only the mechanics of the Zoho Creator Form Builder but also the underlying database design principles — primary keys, composite fields, enumerated choice lists, and one-to-many / many-to-many relationships — that any well-designed business application depends on.

Specifically, this experiment aims to:

- Identify a real registration workflow that benefits from digitization and advance data capture.
- Translate the identified workflow into a formal Entity–Relationship data model with clearly defined entities, attributes and cardinalities.
- Configure a Zoho Creator form that uses an appropriate Basic Field for every captured attribute, complete with mandatory-field and format validations.

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2. Procedure

2.1 Problem Statement & Application Scope

A college technical event on agentic automation and RPA currently collects participant interest through phone calls, WhatsApp messages and walk-in sign-ups, which leads to duplicate entries, no advance record of how many attendees to expect per track, and no way for the organizing team to arrange kits, seating and session material before the event date. Organizers frequently under- or over-provision resources because there is no single, structured record of who is attending, from which institution, and what they expect from the event.

This lack of structured intake also makes it difficult to plan session logistics: without knowing in advance how many participants prefer a given track, or what background they come from (student, faculty, or industry professional), the organizing committee cannot allocate rooms, mentors or lab systems efficiently. A single registration form must therefore double up as both a sign-up mechanism and a planning tool, with data captured in a structured, validated, and instantly reportable form.

Design a low-code application using Zoho Creator that allows a participant to register for the event through a single online form. The form must capture participant identity, contact details, institution address, team size, session date and track preference, expectations from the event, participant category, and consent to the code of conduct — using the relevant Basic Field types provided by Zoho Creator's Form Builder.

2.2 Data Model & ER Diagram

A Data Model consists of both the visual Entity–Relationship (ER) diagram showing schema relationships and the structured Data Dictionary table defining field types and constraints. The diagram below represents the schema generated for Event_Registration_Form, showing the primary form entity, composite data structures, and the choice/lookup entities, connected through explicit relationships with cardinality (1:1, 1:N, M:N).

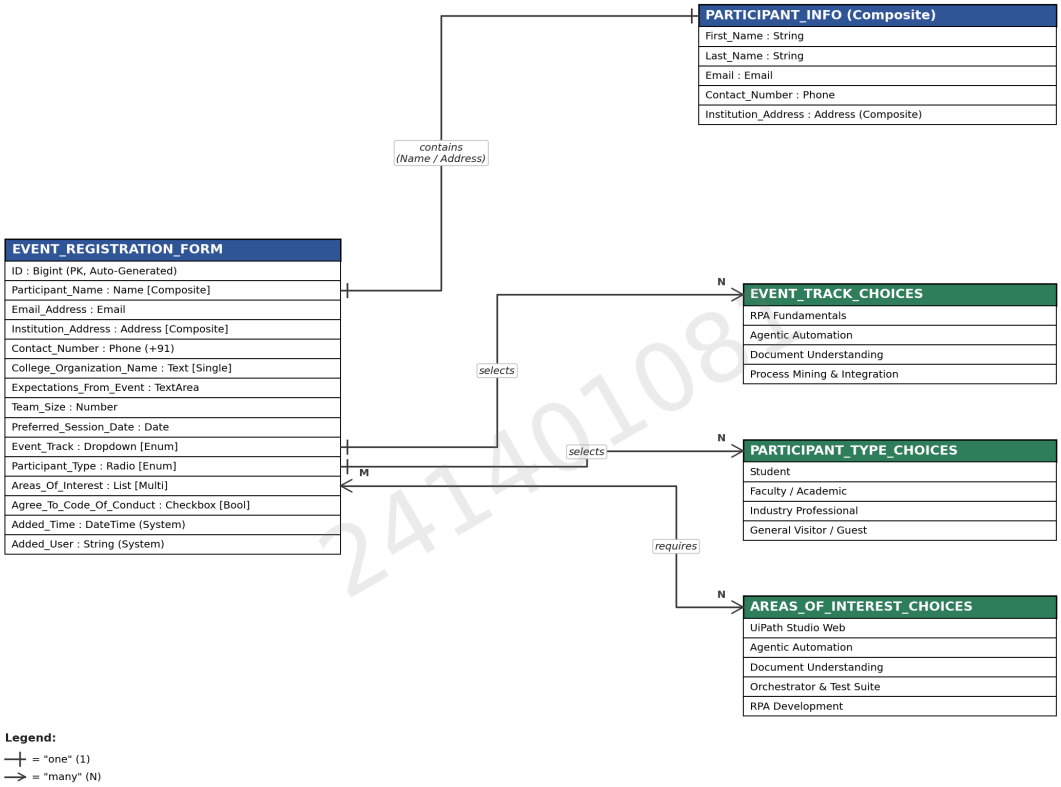


Figure 1: Entity–Relationship (ER) Schema Diagram for Event Registration Form

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2.3 Basic Fields Mapping & Data Dictionary

Table 1 presents the mapping of the twelve Basic Fields from the Zoho Creator Form Builder palette used in this form to their specific roles, purpose, and general sample values.

Basic Field	Form Field Name	Field Link Name	Purpose & Validation Constraints	Sample Value
Name	Participant Name	Participant_Name	Captures the full name of the participant using First / Last subfields (Mandatory).	Sindu MG
Email	Email Address	Email_Address	Captures a validated email address for sending registration confirmation and event updates.	sindu.mg.2024.csbs@rajalakshmi.edu.in
Address	Institution Address	Institution_Address	Captures the participant's institution address (Address Line 1/2, City / District, State / Province, Postal Code, Country).	REC Campus, Thandalam, Chennai, TN, 602105, Chennai, Tamil Nadu, 600099, India
Phone	Contact Number	Contact_Number	Captures a validated mobile number with country code, used to confirm registration and send reminders.	+91 9600077889
Single Line	College / Organization Name	College_Organization_Name	Captures a short free-text name of the participant's college or organization (Mandatory).	Rajalakshmi Engineering College
Multi Line	Expectations From Event	Expectations_From_Event	Captures a free-text description of what the participant hopes to gain from the event.	Looking forward to hands-on exposure to agentic automation using UiPath Studio Web.
Number	Team Size	Team_Size	Captures the number of members attending as part of the participant's team (Mandatory, must be positive).	3
Date	Preferred Session Date	Preferred_Session_Date	Captures the date on which the participant prefers to attend the session.	20-Aug-2026
Drop Down	Event Track	Event_Track	Presents a single-select list of available event tracks.	Agentic Automation
Radio	Participant Type	Participant_Type	Captures a single mandatory selection among Student / Faculty-Academic / Industry Professional / General Visitor-Guest.	Student
Multi Select	Areas Of Interest	Areas_Of_Interest	Allows selection of one or more topics the participant is interested in.	UiPath Studio Web, Agentic Automation
Checkbox	Agree To Code Of Conduct	Agree_To_Code_Of_Conduct	Captures the participant's consent to the event's Terms of Service & Privacy Policy (Mandatory).	Checked (Agreed)

Table 1: Mapping and Specification of the Basic Fields in Event_Registration_Form

2.4 Form Layout & Configuration Steps

The Event_Registration_Form was organized into four logical, participant-friendly sections:

- **Section A — Participant Identification:** Participant Name (Name), Email Address (Email), Contact Number (Phone).
- **Section B — Institutional Details:** Institution Address (Address), College/Organization Name (Single Line).
- **Section C — Event Scheduling:** Preferred Session Date (Date), Event Track (Drop Down), Team Size (Number).
- **Section D — Expectations & Consent:** Expectations From Event (Multi Line), Participant Type (Radio), Areas Of Interest (Multi Select), Agree To Code Of Conduct (Checkbox).

Grouping the twelve fields into these four sections keeps the form visually manageable despite the number of inputs being captured, and mirrors the natural order in which a participant thinks through their own registration — first “who am I”, then “where am I from”, then “when and what track do I want”, and finally “what do I expect, and do I agree to the terms”. Each section header in the live form is rendered in a distinct accent colour so that participants can visually track their progress as they scroll down the page.

Field-level validation was configured for every mandatory field, marked with an asterisk in the Form Builder. The Email field enforces a valid email pattern before submission is allowed; the Phone field restricts entry to a valid mobile number and prepends the country code selector (defaulted to +91 for this event); the Number field used for Team Size rejects non-numeric and negative input; and the Date field constrains entry to the dd-MMM-yyyy format through a calendar picker rather than free text. The Checkbox field for Agree_To_Code_Of_Conduct is set as mandatory so that the Submit action is blocked until the participant explicitly accepts the Terms of Service & Privacy Policy, which keeps the registration record legally and administratively complete before it reaches the organizing team.

Finally, the Drop Down (Event_Track), Radio (Participant_Type) and Multi Select (Areas_Of_Interest) fields were each backed by a fixed choice list configured directly in the Form Builder, which keeps the values consistent across every submission and makes it straightforward to filter and group records in the All_Event_Registrations report — for instance, generating a quick count of participants per track or per participant type without any additional data cleanup.

The Institution_Address field deserves a special mention: because it is configured as a composite Address field rather than a Single Line field, Zoho Creator automatically breaks it down into Address Line 1, Address Line 2, City / District, State / Province, Postal Code and Country sub-components at the database level, even though the participant sees a single, clearly-labelled group of inputs on the form. This is what allows the report view to later be filtered or sorted by city or state if the organizing team ever needs to identify which colleges are sending the most participants, without the field having been designed with that specific analysis in mind from the outset.

Taken together, these configuration choices mean that the Event_Registration_Form is not just a static web form but a small, self-validating database front end: every record that lands in All_Event_Registrations is already clean, complete, and structured in a way that the organizing committee can immediately act on — whether that means printing name badges, grouping participants into track-wise breakout rooms, or simply knowing how many kits to prepare before the event day arrives.

This section-wise configuration approach also makes the form easy to extend for future editions of the event: an additional field such as a T-shirt size or a dietary preference could be dropped into the existing Section D without disturbing the identification or scheduling logic captured earlier in the form, since each section is scoped to a single, well-defined concern rather than mixing unrelated attributes together.

Overall, the layout, validations and choice-list configuration described above satisfy the core objective of this experiment: every Basic Field used in Event_Registration_Form has a clear purpose and a direct role in identifying the participant, scheduling their attendance, or capturing their expectations.

3. Output

The following figures show the live preview of the form and the submitted registration records in the report view:

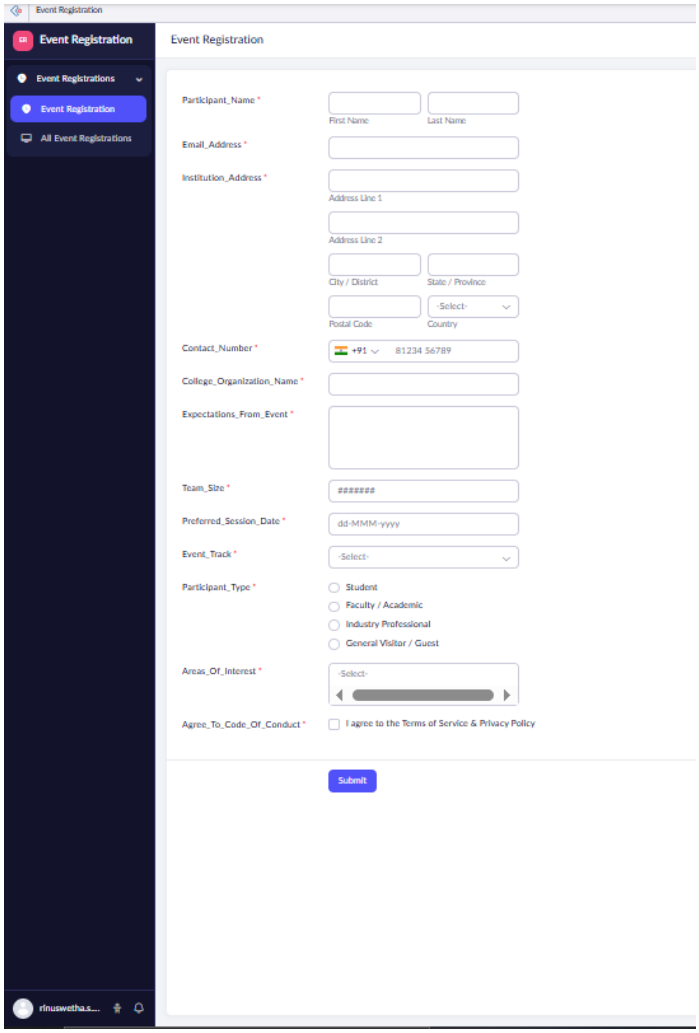


Figure 2: Live Application Runtime Preview for Event_Registration_Form Entry

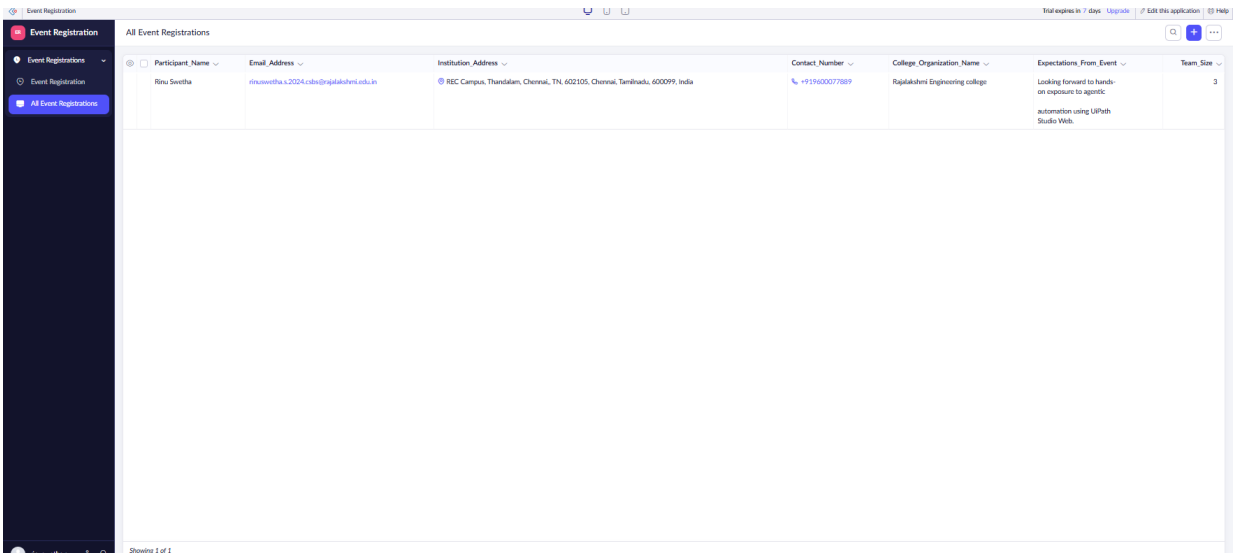


Figure 3: All_Event_Registrations Report View Displaying Submitted Records

4. Result

The “Event Registration Form” application was successfully built in Zoho Creator using the relevant Basic Fields, with full field validations, section layout formatting, ER schema modeling, and report view generation meeting all assignment requirements.

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